

Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Recommendation **BUY** ★★★★★

Price USD 104.72 [as of market close Oct 27, 2023] 12-Mo. Target Price USD 135.00 Report Currency USD Investment Style Large-Cap Blend

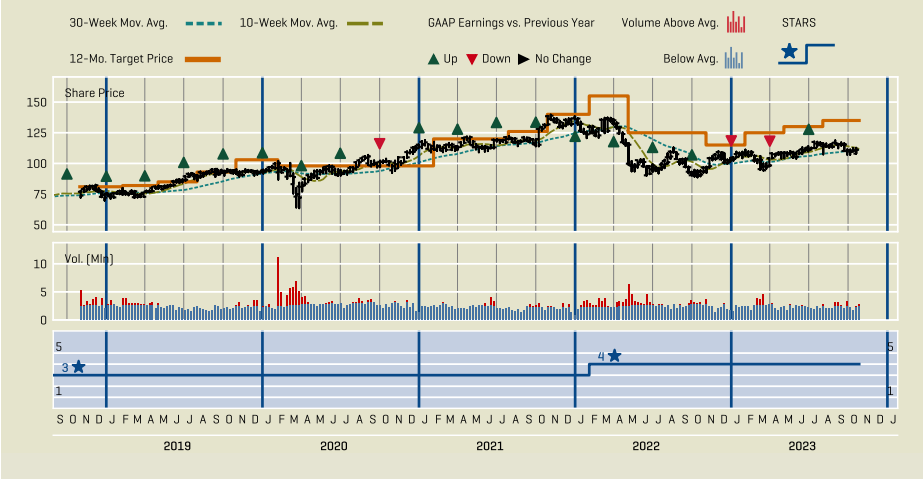
Equity Analyst Alexander Yokum

GICS Sector Financials Sub-Industry Financial Exchanges and Data

Summary ICE is a provider of market infrastructure, data services, and technology solutions. Products include futures, equities, fixed income, and residential mortgages.

Key Stock Statistics (Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports)									
52-Wk Range	USD 118.79 - 92.26	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 5.72	Market Capitalization[B]	USD 58.67	Beta			0.94
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 5.4	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 6.19	Yield [%]	1.6	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]			7
Trailing 12-Month P/E	19.39	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	18.31	Dividend Rate/Share	USD 1.68	SPGMI's Quality Ranking			A-
USD 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	15,166.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	560.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	USD 1.64	Institutional Ownership [%]			91.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by Alexander Yokum on Sep 05, 2023 10:46 AM ET, when the stock traded at USD 115.62.

Highlights

- ▶ We see organic revenue growth of 4%-6% in 2023 as ICE's recurring revenue [about half of total revenue] continues its momentum. We expect sequential quarterly growth in upcoming quarters to be aided by a rebound in Mortgage Technology transactional revenue. In Q1, this transactional revenue was down 53% Y/Y as mortgage rates remained elevated. This revenue then rebounded 20% sequentially in Q2, but remained more than 60% below 2021 levels. Looking forward, we expect more stable mortgage rates [perhaps even falling in 2024] to lead to an uptick in activity and strong growth in mortgage revenue.
- ▶ Despite continued mortgage headwinds, we were impressed by ICE's adjusted operating margin of 60.0% [+80 bps Y/Y] in Q2 as adjusted expenses rose just 2%. Looking at full-year 2023, we see expansion over 2022's operating margin of 59% and expect an operating margin of 60% as revenue growth outpaces higher employee and technology spend.
- ▶ On September 5, 2023, ICE closed its acquisition of Black Knight for \$11.9 billion. In order to get the deal done, the two companies agreed to sell Black Knight's Optimal Blue business to Constellation Software for \$700 million.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- ▶ In a world full of uncertainty, we view shares of ICE favorably as the company has an unprecedented ability to perform in all market environments. Not only was ICE able to grow earnings before, during, and after the pandemic, but ICE has seen earnings growth in each year since it went public in 2005. Furthermore, we forecast its mortgage technology business will continue to gain market share and create cross-sell opportunities. With the acquisition of Black Knight, ICE has the opportunity to take a stranglehold on the industry by offering both standardized and customized products to its customers. Additionally, we are encouraged by ICE's recurring revenue growth, which decreases the firm's reliance on trading volumes.
- ▶ Risks to our recommendation and target price include greater-than-expected competition or weakening in the derivative markets, a significant decline in trading volumes, tighter regulatory guidelines that may limit data pricing power, and a slowing global economy.
- ▶ On August 3, we increased our 12-month target price by \$5 to \$135, reflecting a P/E of 21.8x our 2024 EPS estimate, in line with ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW MEDIUM HIGH

Our risk assessment reflects the volatility of product trading volumes, the potential impact of future regulatory changes, and ever-present competition from established exchanges as well as upstarts. Additionally, integration and execution risk stems from the recently completed Black Knight (BKI) acquisition. This risk is partly offset by ICE's strong franchise, growing diversification of products and services, and resilient recurring revenue.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 2,019	E 2,047	E 2,048	E 2,066	E 8,180
2023	1,896	1,888	E 1,921	E 1,941	E 7,646
2022	1,899	1,814	1,811	1,768	7,292
2021	1,797	1,707	1,802	1,840	7,146
2020	1,559	1,395	1,411	1,671	6,036
2019	1,270	1,298	1,336	1,298	5,202

Earnings Per Share (USD)

	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 1.53	E 1.52	E 1.56	E 1.58	E 6.19
2023	1.41	1.43	E 1.42	E 1.46	E 5.72
2022	1.43	1.32	1.31	1.25	5.30
2021	1.34	1.16	1.30	1.34	5.15
2020	1.28	1.07	1.03	1.13	4.51
2019	0.92	0.94	1.06	0.95	3.88

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [USD]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.4200	Aug 03	Sep 14	Sep 15	Sep 29 '23
0.4200	May 04	Jun 14	Jun 15	Jun 30 '23
0.4200	Feb 02	Mar 16	Mar 17	Mar 31 '23
0.3800	Nov 03	Dec 14	Dec 15	Dec 30 '22

Dividends have been paid since 2013 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.



Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Business Summary Sep 05, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW. Intercontinental Exchange [ICE] is a provider of market infrastructure, data services, and technology solutions to financial institutions, corporations, and government entities. ICE’s products include futures, equities, fixed income, and residential mortgages. Approximately two thirds of ICE’s revenue comes from the U.S., with the remaining coming from the U.K. and to a lesser extent, Europe, Israel, Canada, and Singapore.

ICE was formed in May 2000 to provide a platform for OTC energy trading. In June 2001, the company acquired the International Petroleum Exchange [IPE], which was mainly a floor-based futures exchange. In early 2002, the company introduced the industry’s first cleared OTC contract through its partnership with LCH.Clearnet. In April 2005, ICE closed the IPE trading floor and moved to an entirely electronic marketplace. In January 2007, ICE acquired the New York Board of Trade [NYBOT] for approximately \$1.1 billion. NYBOT, which has been renamed ICE Futures U.S., is a leading soft commodity exchange for products such as sugar, coffee, cocoa, orange juice, pulp, and cotton, as well as several financial products.

With the major acquisition of Ellie Mae completed, ICE reorganized its business into three segments:

1) Exchanges [56% of 2022 revenue], which provides listing, trading, and clearing of a broad array of derivatives contracts and financial securities, such as commodities, interest rates, foreign exchange, and equities as well as corporate and exchange-traded funds, or ETFs; 2) Fixed Income and Data Services [29% of 2022 revenue], which includes fixed income pricing, reference data, indices, analytics, and execution services as well as global credit default swaps, clearing and multi-asset class data delivery solutions; and 3) Mortgage Technology [16% of 2022 revenue], which offers customers digital workflow tools that aim to address the inefficiencies that exist in the U.S. residential mortgage market, from application through closing and the secondary market.

IMPACT OF MAJOR DEVELOPMENTS. On May 4, 2022, ICE announced a definitive agreement to acquire Black Knight [BKI] a software company that creates software, data, and analytics for the real estate and housing-finance markets. The transaction was valued at \$13.1 billion. However, in early 2023, the transaction value was lowered after BKI announced it was looking to sell its Empower loan origination system in an effort to win clearance for the merger from regulators. With clearance secured, the acquisition closed on September 5, 2023 for \$11.9 billion. The acquisition expanded ICE’s product set and added a customized product to ICE’s current standardized model.

On October 15, 2021, Bakkt completed its merger with VPC Impact Acquisition Holdings [VIH], a special purpose acquisition company. The business combination between Bakkt and VIH resulted in an enterprise value of approximately \$2.1 billion. The newly combined company was renamed Bakkt Holdings, Inc. and is listed on the New York Stock Exchange with ICE initially holding a 68% economic interest in the company. Bakkt is an integrated platform that enables customers and consumers to transact in digital assets.

In August 2020, ICE announced a definitive agreement to acquire Ellie Mae, a leading cloud-based platform provider for the mortgage industry, for \$11 billion [paid for with \$9.25 billion in newly issued debt and \$1.75 billion in stock]. The acquisition enhanced ICE’s mortgage business and transformed the company to be a significant player in the digitization of the entire mortgage process. The transaction built on ICE’s previous acquisition of MERS and Simplifile, both of which are focused on the post-closing activities, while Ellie Mae focuses on the origination process. As a result, ICE’s revenue from the mortgage business went from less than 2% of total revenues to 20%. We understand the strategic rationale and like that ICE is positioning itself ahead of an inevitable trend of digitizing mortgages, but are disappointed in the high price paid. Ellie Mae was valued at only \$3.7 billion in 2019, and the \$11 billion price was equal to a lofty 23.4x EV/EBITDA ratio and 12.2x sales. ICE closed the acquisition on September 4, 2020.

In December 2015, ICE closed on the \$5.2 billion acquisition of Interactive Data, one of the world’s leading providers of financial data and data services. IDC boosted data service revenues to nearly half of total consolidated revenues. The IDC business with its market data and pricing offering had stable recurring revenue with multi-year customer contracts and over a 90% renewal rate. Following the IDC acquisition, the company’s suite of data products included an expanded range of fixed income pricing and reference data, analytics, and trading service offerings. Through ICE’s trading, clearing, listings, data services, and post-trade platforms, the company brings together buyers and sellers by offering liquid markets, benchmark products, access to capital markets, information, and a range of related services to support market participants like investing, risk management, and capital raising activities.

In November 2013, ICE announced the completion of its previously announced acquisition of NYSE Euronext. The stock-and-cash transaction had a total value of approximately \$11 billion. At closing, the combined company operated 16 global exchanges and five central clearing houses.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. We think the company’s trading volumes have benefited from significant market volatility and increased investor interest in alternative investments like energy products. Despite benefiting from market volatility, ICE has also made a concerted effort to increase its recurring revenues with 51% of total revenue coming from recurring revenue in 2022, up from 34% in 2014. ICE’s balance sheet became more levered after the Ellie Mae acquisition and remains elevated as ICE paid for a portion of the Black Knight acquisition with debt. As of June 30, 2023, ICE had a total debt-to-EBITDA ratio of 3.6x, well above the 2.5x level pre- Ellie Mae acquisition.

Corporate information

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Officers	
Chief Technology Officer M. V. Kapani	President B. R. Jackson
Chief Financial Officer A. W. Gardiner	Chief Accounting Officer & Corporate Controller J. W. Namkung
General Counsel A. J. Surdykowski	Founder, Chairman & CEO J. C. Sprecher
Chief Operating Officer S. G. Williams	

Board Members	
C. L. Silver	M. F. Mulhern
D. M. Farooqui	R. Lord Hague
H. C. Serafini	S. E. Cooper
J. A. Sprieser	S. Y. Bowen
J. C. Sprecher	T. E. Noonan
M. A. Tirinnanzi	Y. Lee

Domicile Delaware	Auditor Ernst & Young LLP
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Founded
2000

Employees
9,116

Stockholders
492



Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Quantitative Evaluations					
Fair Value Rank	1	2	3	4	5
	LOWEST		HIGHEST		
	Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).				
Fair Value Calculation	USD 91.11	Analysis of the stock's current worth, based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model suggests that ICE is overvalued by USD 13.61 or 13.00%			
Volatility	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH
Technical Evaluation	NEUTRAL	Since August, 2023, the technical indicators for ICE have been NEUTRAL"			
Insider Activity	UNFAVORABLE	NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE	

Expanded Ratio Analysis				
	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	7.89	10.81	10.60	10.05
Price/EBITDA	12.75	17.79	17.30	16.70
Price/Pretax Income	31.83	13.56	23.13	21.08
P/E Ratio	19.36	26.56	25.56	23.85
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	561.00	565.00	555.00	565.00
Figures based on fiscal year-end price				
Key Growth Rates and Averages				
Past Growth Rate [%]		1 Year	3 Years	5 Years
Net Income		NM	NM	NM
Sales		2.04	11.92	9.47
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)				
Net Margin [%]		19.83	37.08	37.66
% LT Debt to Capitalization		43.97	38.71	32.59
Return on Equity [%]		6.58	12.40	12.06

Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Sub-Industry Outlook

We have a positive fundamental outlook on the Financial Exchanges & Data sub-industry for the next 12 months.

As a group, the major U.S. exchanges have grown EPS at nearly double the speed of the S&P 500 over last decade and impressively, were able to grow before, during, and after the pandemic. With rapid innovation in the exchange space, we expect most exchanges to continue to grow EPS at high-single digits as they continue to judiciously meet client needs with new products and services.

We believe a side effect of recent bank failures could be increased derivative activity. CME's CEO, Terrence Duffy, is known for stating that clients need to manage risk before shocks occur, not after the shock has already occurred. Given the collapse of Silicon Valley Bank and increased scrutiny on interest rate exposure, we expect bank executives to lean more heavily on exchange-traded products like swaps or futures to manage their risk. Until recently, this risk was largely unhedged as a decade-plus of low interest rates led banking teams to prioritize credit risk over interest rate risk. However, we expect the use of these products to increase materially, and we note the banking industry has enormous exposure with total assets of nearly \$23 trillion.

Data providers, largely the rating agencies, have struggled over the last year and a half as geopolitical uncertainty, slow economic growth, and a hawkish Federal Reserve have severely impacted debt issuance volumes. Many corporations came into this period from a position of power as they pulled forward debt issuance in 2020 and 2021 to take advantage of historically low interest rates. As a result, corporations have sat on the sidelines when possible, resulting in corporate debt-to-GDP levels falling from a high of 57% in the second quarter of 2020 to under 49% as of the second quarter of 2023. However, we see 2022 and early 2023 as a low watermark for debt issuance and expect issuance levels to rise into 2024 as the uncertainty of 2022 and early 2023 moderates. We see issuance momentum continuing through 2025 as a growing level of

corporate-rated debt matures and needs to be replaced. As a result, we expect credit rating agencies to see improving performance as cost-cutting measures are met with improving debt issuance conditions. An added benefit should come from the analytics businesses, which help smooth out transaction-related revenues, given the acyclical nature of analytics revenue.

We see index providers as well positioned over the long term as we expect growth to generally outpace the overall market as index providers continue to benefit from the slow move of funds from active to passive. Looking over the next 12 months, we expect revenue exposure to indices to turn from a headwind to a tailwind as weak comps lead to outsized growth in upcoming quarters.

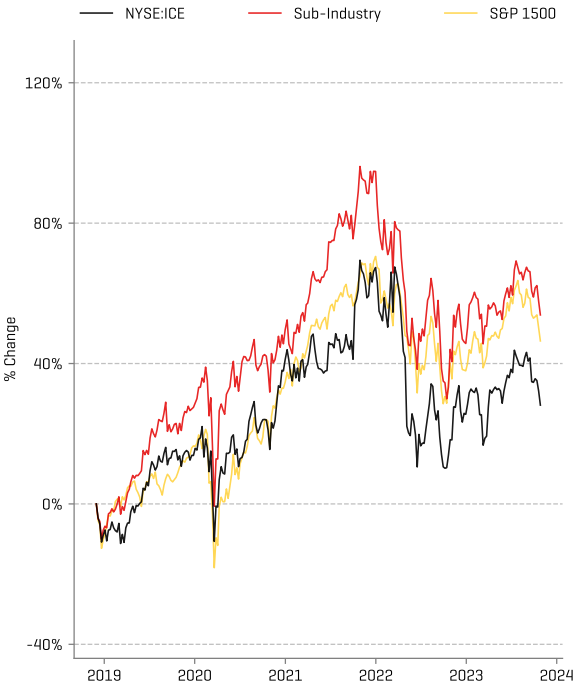
YTD as of September 22, the Financial Exchanges & Data sub-industry was up 10.2% compared to the Financials sector down 2.4% and the S&P Composite 1500 up 11.6%. For full-year 2022, the sub-industry fell 25.2% compared to the Financials sector down 12.1% and the S&P 1500 down 19.1%.

/ Alexander Yokum

Industry Performance

GICS Sector: Financials
Sub-Industry: Financial Exchanges and Data

Based on S&P 1500 Indexes
Five-Year market price performance through Oct 28, 2023



NOTE: A sector chart appears when the sub-industry does not have sufficient historical index data.
All Sector & Sub-Industry information is based on the Global Industry Classification Standard (GICS).
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence

Sub-Industry: Financial Exchanges and Data Peer Group*: Financial Exchanges and Data												
Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.	ICE	NYSE	USD	107.29	60,115.0	0.1	14.3	20.0	91.11	1.6	7.5	42.9
CME Group Inc.	CME	NasdaqGS	USD	215.43	77,501.0	7.8	25.3	24.0	162.42	2.0	10.8	10.8
Coinbase Global, Inc.	COIN	NasdaqGS	USD	74.61	17,696.0	5.8	1.1	NM	N/A	N/A	-22.1	36.0
FactSet Research Systems Inc.	FDS	NYSE	USD	429.06	16,367.0	-0.7	2.7	30.0	359.55	0.9	31.7	46.6
MSCI Inc.	MSCI	NYSE	USD	481.55	38,085.0	-6.7	6.6	40.0	391.05	1.1	-82.6	129.9
MarketAxess Holdings Inc.	MKTX	NasdaqGS	USD	212.60	8,059.0	3.4	-10.8	32.0	200.48	1.4	22.4	N/A
Moody's Corporation	MCO	NYSE	USD	310.09	56,888.0	-1.7	20.7	33.0	269.09	1.0	52.4	64.5
Morningstar, Inc.	MORN	NasdaqGS	USD	248.00	10,578.0	3.7	12.6	150.0	N/A	0.6	5.9	41.2
Nasdaq, Inc.	NDAQ	NasdaqGS	USD	49.70	24,418.0	3.6	-17.2	18.0	34.52	1.8	17.8	58.5
S&P Global Inc.	SPGI	NYSE	USD	348.26	110,816.0	-4.3	11.8	30.0	238.90	1.0	6.4	20.8
Tradeweb Markets Inc.	TW	NasdaqGS	USD	87.88	18,594.0	9.0	63.5	44.0	N/A	0.4	6.9	N/A

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

August 03, 2023

02:48 PM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 111.43****]:

We increase our 12-month target price by \$5 to \$135, reflecting a P/E of 21.8x our 2024 EPS estimate, in line with ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x. We raise our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.07 to \$5.72 and increase 2024's by \$0.06 to \$6.19. ICE posted Q2 adj. EPS of \$1.43 vs. \$1.32 a year earlier, beating consensus by \$0.06. Revenue growth of 4% was driven by the Exchange segment (+9% Y/Y & 57% of revenue) as results benefited from a surge in energy and agriculture activity. Fixed Income & Data Services (+7% & 29% of total revenue) increased on strength in ICE bonds and the CDS clearing business. However, results continue to be negatively impacted by Mortgage Technology (-16% Y/Y & 14% of revenue) as industry activity remains severely muted. Despite this weakness, we were encouraged by the adj. operating margin, which expanded 80 bps to 60.0%. With expectations for an improved mortgage environment in 2024, we expect ICE to report continued margin expansion as well as record revenue and EPS. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

May 04, 2023

03:20 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 106.65****]:

We increase our target price by \$5 to \$130, reflecting a P/E of 21.2x our '24 EPS estimate, in line with ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x. We raise our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.07 to \$5.65 and decrease '24's by \$0.03 to \$6.13. ICE posts Q1 adj. EPS of \$1.41 vs. \$1.43 a year earlier, beating consensus by \$0.01. ICE's countercyclicality was on display following several prominent banking failures as it reported record adj. revenue in its Exchange segment (+3% Y/Y & 56% of revenue). Record revenue was also seen in Fixed Income & Data Services (29% of total revenue) as growth in ICE bonds and the CDS clearing business led to 12% adj. revenue growth. Despite strong growth, we were impressed by expense management (-1%) as ICE's adj. operating margin improved 30 bps to 61.0%. Revenue was well balanced in the quarter with 50% from transaction revenue and 50% from recurring sources. We maintain Buy given an attractive valuation and expectations for improvement in Mortgage Technology (-23% Y/Y & 15% of revenue). / Alexander Yokum, CFA

February 02, 2023

10:58 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 109.19****]:

We increase our target price by \$10 to \$125, reflecting a P/E of 22.4x our '23 EPS estimate, a slight premium to ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x. We reduce our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.16 to \$5.58 and start '24's at \$6.16. ICE posts Q4 adj. EPS of \$1.25 vs. \$1.34 a year earlier, missing consensus by \$0.01. The slowdown in Mortgage Technology (15% of revenue) continued in the quarter as a collapse in industry origination volumes led to a 57% Y/Y drop in transaction revenue. However, we see Mortgage Technology revenue rebounding throughout '23 as interest rates stabilize and recurring revenues (+10% Y/Y) continue to grow. Adj. Exchange revenue (56% of total revenue) fell 1% on weakness in energy and financials. Strength was seen in Fixed Income & Data Services (29% of total revenue) as market volatility and an elevated interest rate regime led to adj. revenue growth of 13%. Despite a relatively tough quarter, we were reassured by ICE's expense management as employee compensation fell 5% from a year ago. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

November 03, 2022

11:08 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 97.16****]:

We lower our 12-month target price by \$10 to \$115, reflecting a P/E of 20.1x to our '23 EPS estimate, a discount to ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x given slowing revenue growth. We reduce our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.05 to \$5.37 and '23's by \$0.08 to \$5.74. ICE posted Q3 adj. EPS of \$1.31 vs. \$1.30 a year ago, beating consensus by \$0.04. We believe ICE's resilience was on full display in the quarter as Mortgage Technology revenue (17% of total revenue) fell 25% vs. the industry, which saw origination volumes collapse nearly 60%. Despite the tough mortgage environment, total FX adj. revenue actually grew 3% on 14% growth in Fixed Income & Data Services (27% of total revenue) as market volatility and rising interest rates benefited results. Exchange revenue (56% of total revenue) grew 8% on strength in both transaction revenue and recurring revenue. ICE's ability to grow in all market conditions continues to impress and we note that ICE has grown adj. EPS in each year since it went public in 2005. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

August 04, 2022

10:25 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 107.91****]:

We maintain our 12-month target price of \$125, reflecting a P/E of 21.5x to our '23 EPS estimate, in line with ICE's 10-year average of 21.4x. We reduce our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.16 to \$5.42 and '23's by \$0.22 to \$5.82. ICE posts Q2 adj. EPS of \$1.32 vs. \$1.16 a year ago, beating consensus by \$0.05. Revenue rose 6% Y/Y as results benefited from an 11% increase in the Exchange segment (55% of total revenue). On the flip side, Mortgage Technology (18% of revenue) saw revenue fall 13% as rising interest rates led to a softening in mortgage originations. However, we view these results as impressive given the steep decline in industry wide mortgage activity and the fact that ICE grew its mortgage recurring revenue by 18%. Going forward, we continue to see mortgage technology as an exciting growth driver for ICE given the highly inefficient nature of the industry, which in our view, provides ample opportunity for ICE to innovate and take market share. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

May 05, 2022

11:09 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange, Inc. [ICE 105.20****]:

We lower our 12-month target price by \$30 to \$125, reflecting a P/E of 20.7x to our '23 EPS estimate, a slight discount to ICE's 10-year average of 21.3x. We reduce our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.08 to \$5.58 and '23's by \$0.20 to \$6.04. ICE posts Q1 adj. EPS of \$1.43 vs. \$1.34 a year ago, beating consensus by \$0.01. Revenue jumped 6% Y/Y, as the Exchange segment (+12%) benefited from a 36% increase in interest rate futures and a 16% increase in energy revenues. Mortgage Technology revenue fell 13% Y/Y, but we are encouraged as growing recurring revenue partially insulated the segment from plummeting origination and refinance volumes. ICE also announced a deal to acquire mortgage software provider Black Knight (BKI) for \$13.1B (80% cash and 20% stock). We view the anticipated deal cost synergies of \$200M as on the lighter end but take solace as it should lower antitrust issues. Additionally, we are encouraged by BKI's predictable revenue stream and like ICE's further push into the inefficient mortgage space. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

February 03, 2022

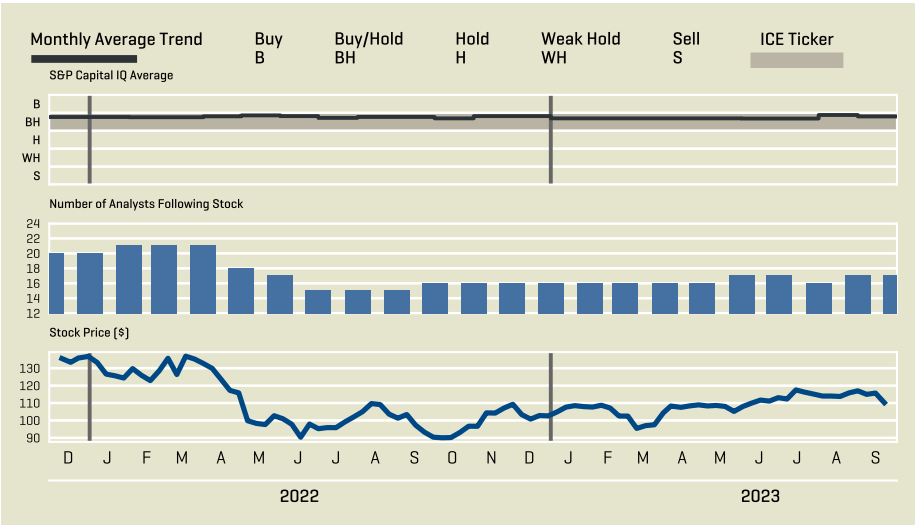
12:22 PM ET... CFRA Upgrades to Buy from Hold Opinion on Shares of Intercontinental Exchange [ICE 127.06****]:

We see ICE delivering strong returns as its mortgage technology business continues to gain market share and creates cross sell opportunities. We raise our 12-month target price by \$15 to \$155, reflecting a P/E of 24.8x to our '23 EPS estimate, higher than ICE's 10-year average of 22.5x. We increase our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.29 to \$5.66 and start '23's at \$6.24. ICE posts Q4 adj. EPS of \$1.34 vs. \$1.15 a year ago, beating consensus by \$0.02. Revenue in the exchange segment was up 17% Y/Y on a 71% increase in the interest rate business and a 28% increase in energy. Fixed income and data revenue was up 7%, driven by strength in the index franchise. Mortgage technology revenue was down 1%, as a 15% decline in transaction revenue more than offset a 26% increase in recurring revenue. In '22, we see 6%-8% growth in ICE's recurring revenue (49% of total revenue) on the back of strong growth in mortgage technology. With reasonable cost control efforts, we see 59%-60% operating margins in '22 vs. 58.3% in '21. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Intercontinental Exchange, Inc.

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	9	53	9	8
Buy/Hold	4	24	4	4
Hold	4	24	4	5
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	17	100	17	17

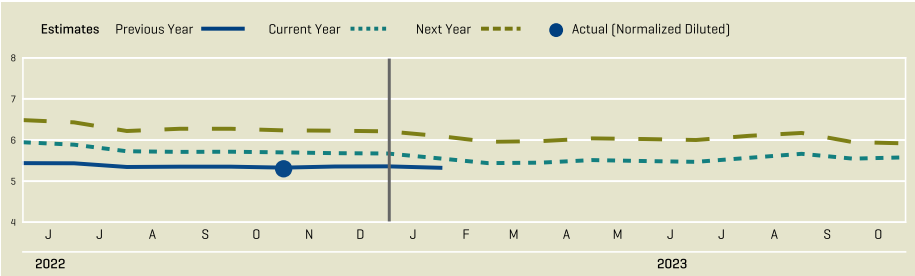
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that ICE will earn USD 5.58. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that ICE's earnings per share will grow by 6.12% to USD 5.92.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	5.92	6.15	5.70	13	18.13
2023	5.58	5.87	5.36	13	19.24
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 6%	▲ 5%	▲ 6%	N/A%	▼ -6%
Q3'24	1.50	1.57	1.44	8	71.36
Q3'23	1.39	1.44	1.29	13	77.29
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 8%	▲ 9%	▲ 12%	▼ -38%	▼ -8%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

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Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsule the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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